

MICROBES IN ACTION

The world would be very different without microbes. From breaking down dead things to making oxygen for us to breathe, these pages only show a little of what they do.



Plant doctor

Some fungi, such as *Trichoderma citrinoviride*, live inside plants and make antibiotics (a type of medicine) for them to fight diseases.

Air maker

Humans need oxygen to breathe, but the air wouldn't be quite so full of it without bacteria! Some bacteria make this all-important gas.



Disease causer

Phytophthora infestans is a microbe that causes a disease in potatoes and tomatoes, called blight. It is responsible for many historic food shortages.



Nostoc is a group of bacteria that makes oxygen.